

9: Inequality

Introduction: Origins of Inequality, and Its Inevitability

Modern societies are defined by differentiation, and so inevitably the question arises of how those differences are to be interrelated.

However, there are an enormous number of axes of inequality--that is, bases on which to arrange relationships.

The degree of inequality is also important, and much contemporary argument involves the distinction between absolute and relative inequality.

There are also enormous consequences to inequality, both absolute and relative.

Contemporary Inequalities of Note: Global, National, Local

Global inequality: the GINI coefficient and global absolute poverty.

National inequality: relative poverty, health, and its consequences

Local inequality: Census Tract Analysis of Long Island Communities

Poverty and Perversity: Moralized Contemporary Debates About Inequality

Address contemporary debates about inequality, and demonstrate their roots in values.